GG-P-00581D(DSA-DM)
October 18, 1973
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec
GG-P-00581c(DSA-DM)
August 3, 1966, and
Fed. Spec. GG-P-581b
April 21, 1958

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

POINTS, PULP CANAL, DENTAL, PAPER

This interim Federal specification was developed by the Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above. The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this interim Federal specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification GG-P-581b.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers sterile absorbent paper points suitable for use in endodontic procedures.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Sizes. Absorbent paper points shall be of the following sizes, as specified (see 6.1):

Size 1.	Extra extra fine
Size 2.	Extra fine
Size 3.	Fine
Size 4.	Medium
Size 5.	Coarse
Size 6.	Extra coarse

FSC 6520

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2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

PPP-B-566	Box, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585	Box, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	Box, Wood, Cleated-plywood.
PPP-B-621	Box, Wood, Nailed and Lock-corner.
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	Box, Setup.

(Activities, outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.)

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.)

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

SPECIFICATIONS

Military

MIL-S-36586	Sterilization Test Strip Set, Bacterial Spore.
MIL-L-10547	Liners, Case and Sheet, Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof Or Waterproof, Flexible.

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STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 OTHER PUBLICATIONS. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

TECHNICAL ASSOCIATION OF THE PULP AND PAPER INDUSTRY (TAPPI)

T 410 OS-68	Weight Per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, 360 Lexington Avenue, N.Y., N.Y. 10017)

THE UNITED STATES PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

The Pharmacopeia of the United States of America.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, Pa. 18042.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Pulp canal points shall be made of a fine grade of bibulous paper. Bibulous paper shall be white and shall have a smooth lintless surface and a close texture. Basis weight of the paper shall be as specified in table I for the applicable point when tested as specified in 4.4.4.

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Table I. Basis Weight

Point Size	Basis Weight - Ream Size
X-X-Fine (Size 1)	7.7 ± 1.2 pounds (24 x 36 - 480 sheets)
X-Fine (Size 2)	9.5 ± 1.4 pounds (24 x 36 - 480 sheets)
Fine (Size 3)	9.5 ± 1.4 pounds (24 x 36 - 480 sheets)
Medium (Size 4)	9.5 ± 1.4 pounds (24 x 36 - 480 sheets)
Coarse (Size 5)	9.5 ± 1.4 pounds (24 x 36 - 480 sheets)
X-Coarse (Size 6)	14.0 ± 2.1 pounds (24 x 36 - 480 sheets)

3.2 Design and construction. The paper pulp canal points shall be sterile, absorbent, and suitable for use in endodontic procedures. The points shall be tightly rolled and uniformly tapered. Paper pulp canal points shall be furnished in the sizes specified in table II.

3.3 Dimensions. The sterilized points shall have the dimensions shown in table II.

Table II. Point dimensions

Size	Largest diameter at Non-operative End (inches)	Length ± 1/16 (inches)
1 - Extra extra fine	0.0235 ± 0.0025	1
2 - Extra fine	0.0285 ± 0.0025	1
3 - Fine	0.033 ± 0.0.002	1
4 - Medium	0.038 ± 0.003	1
5 - Coarse	0.045 ± 0.004	1-1/8
6 - Extra coarse	0.055 ± 0.004	1-1/8

3.4 Physical properties. The points shall be firm and stiff enough after sterilization to permit insertion into a cavity or pulp canal without collapsing or breaking. The points shall retain their form and shall not disintegrate when immersed in water as specified in 4.4.2. A solution of mercurochrome shall rise to a height of not less than 25 percent of the length of the sterilized point when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

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3.5 Instructions. Each unit of issue (200 points) shall include adequate and accurate instructions for opening immediate container.

3.6 Sterility. The points shall be sterile when tested with a biological indicator as specified in 4.4.3.

3.6.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item identification.
b. National stock number.
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.)
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated simulated product).
i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and dates of tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Directorate of Medical Materiel, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, Pa., 19101, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.

3.6.2 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and simultaneously sterilized in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number and date of sterilization as specified in 5.3.1. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

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3.7 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Points shall be free of disagreeable odor and shall be clean and free of any occluded particles. Points shall be packaged clean and sterile. Points shall be free from defects which may detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Manufacturer's protocol. A manufacturer's protocol, that lists the end item testing characteristics with specification requirements, and which states that test results comply with said requirements, is acceptable, providing the actual test results are made readily available to Government representatives upon request.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection. The examinations and tests required to assure conformance of those items or lots of items to be offered for acceptance are classified as specified in tables III and V (see 4.2.1 and 4.3) table IV (see 4.2.2), and 4.2.3.

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4.2.1 Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) shall be as indicated in table III. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be the immediate container (package of 40 cells).

Table III. Inspection and acceptable quality levels

Type defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	S-2	1.0
Minor	S-2	4.0

4.2.2 Sampling for end item tests. Sampling for end item testing shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and table IV, except that the acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes. Unit of product for test purposes shall be an individual cell (5 points).

Table IV. Tests

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Procedure	Inspection level
Absorption of Mercurochrome	3.4	4.4.1	S-1
Disintegration	3.4	4.4.2	S-1

4.2.3 Sampling for raw material testing. Basis weight test shall be conducted on the raw material (bibulous paper). Sampling and testing shall be conducted in accordance with the applicable Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) standard as specified in 4.4.4. A sufficient amount from each lot of bibulous paper shall be taken for raw material testing.

4.3 Examination. Points shall be examined for defects including, but not limited to, those listed in table V.

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Table V. Classification of defects

Categories	Defects
Major:	
101	Points not free from grease or other foreign matter. 1/
102	Points not tightly rolled.
103	Points not uniformly tapered.
104	Points not firm.
105	Size not as specified.
106	Instructions for opening immediate container not present.
107	Points not free from tears and cuts.
Minor	
201	Packaging and packing not as specified.
202	Marking not as specified.
203	Dimensions not as specified. 1/
204	Unit of issue (quantity) not as specified 1/

1/ In process examination may be used in checking for these defects.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Test for absorption of mercurochrome. The pointed end shall be inserted to a depth of 1 millimeter (mm.) into an aqueous 2 percent mercurochrome solution. At the end of 10 seconds the length of the stain shall be measured. The solution of mercurochrome shall rise to a height of not less than 25 percent of the length of the sterilized point. At least five points shall be tested and the results averaged.

4.4.2 Test for disintegration. The points shall be immersed for 15 minutes in water at 100° ± 2° Fahrenheit (F.). The points shall retain their form and shall not disintegrate.

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4.4.3 Sterility test. The points shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the "Pharmacopeia of the United States of America" (USP) for purified cotton, gauze, surgical dressings and related material, using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in paragraph 4.4.3.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10 cells except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20 cells for Type I Sterilization and 30 cells for Type II Sterilization including inoculated carrier and product test units.

4.4.3.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

Type of Sterilization	Organism	Incubation Temperature
Steam	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C
Dry Heat	B. stearothermophilus, or	55° - 65°C
	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Gas	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Radiation	B. pumilus	30° - 35°C

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

4.4.3.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method of incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated in 4.4.3 Sterility test and 4.4.3.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. The method of sterilization will control the organism in the spore strip to be tested for as shown in 4.4.3.1.

NOTE: When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples must also be tested as required by the USP.

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4.4.3.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a government contract.

4.4.3.4 Product testing. Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the government shall be without a biological indicator and in accordance with the USP.

4.4.4 Basis weight. Basis weight shall be run in accordance with the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Standard T 410 OS-68.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package containing a minimum of 200 points (five cards), as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Packaging quantities. The number of units of issue indicated in table VI shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

Table VI Packaging Quantities

Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
1 unit	12 units	144 units

5.1.2.1 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units to be shipped is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which shall insure safe delivery to destination.

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provided with an integral, electrically powered steam generator. The generator assembly

5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Immediate container. Points shall be sealed in cards so that the points may be used in multiples of five (average) without impairing the sterility of the remaining points. Each unit package of 200 points shall contain five cards divided into dispensing cells. Each cell shall contain a minimum of 4 points with not more than 10 percent of the cells containing 3 points. The card shall be die-cut and made of solid, bleached, sulfate board covered on one side with 1/2 mil clear polyester film and on the other side with blue glassine paper. The card shall be 2 ± 1/32 inches high by 6-5/16 ± 1/4 inches wide by 1/16 ± 1/64 inch thick. The card shall consist of eight 2 ± 1/32 inch high by 51/64 ± 1/32 inch wide sections. Each section shall contain a 1-5/16 ± 1/32 inch by 23/64 ± 1/32 inch wide cell. The card shall be perforated 5/16 ± 1/32 inch below the top. Glassine paper shall be 23 pounds basis weight (24 x 36 inches-500 sheets, TAPPI). Heat seal coating shall be applied to one side of the card for sealing the glassine. Both polyester film and glassine shall be applied with heat and pressure to maintain sterility of the points. The polyester film at each section between cells shall be slit scored and cut above the perforations. The tabs or portion above the perforations shall break off at the perforations and by lifting shall peel off the polyester side and expose the points in one cell without exposing the points in the adjacent cell. The immediate container shall be permanently and legibly marked with the size of the point (Extra extra fine, Extra fine, Fine, Medium, Coarse, or Extra Coarse), as applicable. Abbreviations for size description may be used, example: "X-X-F" for extra extra fine, etc.

5.1.3.2 Unit package. Unit package shall be a carton of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 except that commercial colors will be acceptable. Closure shall be adequate to prevent spilling of contents under normal handling.

5.1.3.3 Intermediate package. Intermediate package shall be a carton of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676, except that commercial colors will be acceptable or PPP-B-636, type CF, class domestic. Closure shall be adequate to prevent spilling of contents under normal handling.

5.1.4 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

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5.2 Level A.

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Fiberboard boxes shall conform to the special requirements as specified in PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.2 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes.

5.2.1.3 Closure. Closure of wood boxes shall be in accordance with appendix of applicable box specification. Closure of each fiberboard box shall be as specified in the appendix, and waterproofing shall conform with 30.4 of PPP-B-636.

5.2.1.4 Strapping. Strapping, when required, shall be in accordance with appendix of applicable box specification.

NOTE: Strapping shall not be required for shipments forwarded to a receiving activity within the continental limits of the United States for storage and redistribution.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Fiberboard boxes shall conform to the special requirements as specified in Table I of PPP-B-636. Closure of wood boxes shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Closure of fiberboard boxes shall conform to method II of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

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5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Unit package. Unit package shall be commercially identified and shall contain adequate instructions for opening the immediate containers. In addition, the unit package shall be marked with the National Stock No., level and date of packaging, unit quantity, lot or control number and an indication that the contents are sterile. In addition, the method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, C-Cold, S-Steam, D-Dry Heat Sterilization) shall be shown following the level of packaging and date of packaging. Example: "A-3/73-G." Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.

5.3.2 Intermediate package. Each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown. In addition, the lot (control) number and the method of sterilization as specified in 5.3.1, shall also be shown.

5.3.3 Exterior container. Exterior containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. The lot (control) number and method of sterilization as specified in 5.3.1 shall also be shown.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Size required (see 1.2).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.2 Specification changes. Because of the extensiveness of changes to this document, the margins have not been marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes from the previous issue have been made.

6.3 Limitations. This specification does not cover all types, classes, grades, styles, or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or those which are commercially available, but is intended to cover those items which are normally procured to meet Federal Government requirements.

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Review activities:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
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Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM
Project No. - 6520 - 1365

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OMB Approval
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1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

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